MODULE 05 · SECURITY

Cybersecurity Awareness

A Custom AI-Generated Companion Guide

Protect yourself, your accounts, and your data — and understand the basics of the field.

DIGITAL GIRLS INITIATIVE PAKISTAN
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5–7 weeks · 3–5 hrs/week

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Welcome & How to Use This Guide

Cybersecurity affects everyone, not just IT professionals — every phishing email, weak password, and oversharing habit is a real risk. This track starts with protecting yourself online, then opens the door to security as a career path, with practical, hands-on practice throughout.

> **Mentor Tip**
> Enable two-factor authentication on your email first — it's the account that can reset every other account.

Estimated time: 5–7 weeks · 3–5 hrs/week · Level: No experience needed

01 Security Foundations

The concepts behind every headline

Before diving into tools, understand the small set of core ideas that every security topic builds on.

01 The CIA triad
Confidentiality, Integrity, and Availability — the three goals of all security work.

02 Common threat types
Malware, phishing, ransomware, and social engineering, explained simply.

03 How breaches actually happen
Most attacks exploit people, not just code — understanding why matters.

04 Key terminology
Vocabulary you'll need to follow any security course or article.

★ Practice Project

Write a one-page 'threat glossary' in your own words for five common attack types.

02 Personal Digital Hygiene

Protecting your own accounts first

The highest-impact security skills are the ones you use on your own devices, every day.

01 Strong passwords & password managers
Why 'P@ssw0rd123' is not strong, and how a password manager fixes this for good.

02 Two-factor authentication
Adding a second lock to every important account.

03 Spotting phishing
The tell-tale signs of a fake email or message trying to steal your credentials.

04 Safe browsing habits
HTTPS, suspicious links, and public Wi-Fi risks.

★ Practice Project
Audit your own top 10 accounts: turn on 2FA everywhere possible and replace any reused passwords.

03 Practical Skills

Going beyond the basics

This phase introduces slightly more technical concepts that show up constantly in security work.

01 Networking basics
IP addresses, routers, and how data actually travels online.

02 VPNs explained
What a VPN does and doesn't protect against.

03 Recognizing social engineering
Scams that manipulate people rather than exploiting code.

04 Securing a device
Updates, device encryption, and app permissions.

★ Practice Project

Do a full privacy and security check-up on your own phone: permissions, updates, and backups.

04 Going Deeper

A first look at security as a field

For anyone curious about security as a career, this phase is a gentle, guided first step into practical, hands-on practice.

01 Ethical hacking, defined
What 'white hat' hacking actually means, and how it differs from crime.

02 Capture-the-flag practice
Beginner-friendly, gamified challenges to practice real skills safely and legally.

03 Security career paths
Analyst, penetration tester, and GRC — an overview of where this can lead.

04 Building a learning habit
Following security news to keep your knowledge current after this course.

★ Practice Project

Complete TryHackMe's beginner-friendly 'Pre Security' path and log what you learned.

Free Video Courses

Curated, highly-rated, and completely free. Pick whichever teaching style fits you best.

> **freeCodeCamp — Cybersecurity for Beginners**
> Full introductory course covering all core concepts
> *https://www.freecodecamp.org/news/tag/cybersecurity/*

> **Professor Messer — Security+ Series**
> Widely used, exam-aligned, entirely free
> *https://www.youtube.com/@professormesser*

> **TryHackMe — Pre Security Path**
> Gamified, hands-on practice for total beginners
> *https://tryhackme.com/path/outline/presecurity*

> **Cybrary — Free Courses**
> Structured intro courses from a dedicated security platform
> *https://www.cybrary.it/*

Your Practice Checklist

Print this page or copy it into a notebook. Check off each project as you finish it — real, working projects are what turn this guide into a portfolio.

- [ ] **Phase 01: Security Foundations — Write a one-page 'threat glossary' in your own words for five commo**
- [ ] **Phase 02: Personal Digital Hygiene — Audit your own top 10 accounts: turn on 2FA everywhere possibl**
- [ ] **Phase 03: Practical Skills — Do a full privacy and security check-up on your own phone: permissions**
- [ ] **Phase 04: Going Deeper — Complete TryHackMe's beginner-friendly 'Pre Security' path and log wha**

Finished all four phases?

Bring your projects to a DG·IP mentor session — we review portfolios and help you plan your next module.

You've got the roadmap.
Now go build something.

This guide is one part of the free DG·IP curriculum. Come back to the website for the live version of this module, curated videos, and seven other free skill tracks.

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